Cowabunga

SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

THU OCT 22, 2026

DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · THU OCT 22 · NORTH PB

The S swell is still running at 15 seconds, but a W breeze is texturing it. Little Point on the drain, 9:30 to noon, and keep it short.

S groundswell, W texture: paddle out by 9:30

PADDLE OUT BY	9:30	BOARD Anvil twin ~73°F WATER

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	9:30a–noon · Anvil twin · ~73°F
SURF	2–4 ft (SRF), S 15s + W windswell, bumpy
TIDE	L 0.6 @ 1:09a H 4.8 @ 7:34a L 1.4 @ 1:33p H 4.7 @ 7:26p obs 5.6 @ 5:54a

Long-period swell keeps its lines under a light onshore breeze.

4 /10

SURF RATING · POOR · LIVE

Poor — quick paddle at best

capped by onshore 10 kt · Better than 3% of 39 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

2–4 FT (SRF), S 15S + W WINDSWELL, BUMPY

GROUND

SwH 3.0–3.3 ft · 13–15s

WINDSWELL

WWH 2.6–3.0 ft · 10s

HS BUOY

Hs 4.3 ft · 46258



FROM

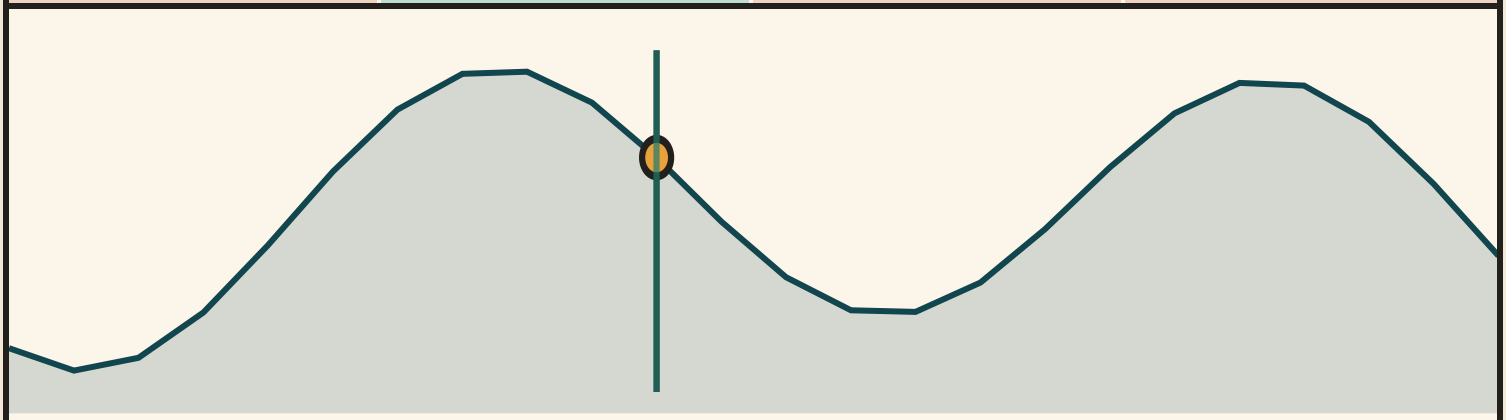
202° SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 4.3 ft @ 15s (spectrum SwH 3.0–3.3 ft @ 13–15s SSW overnight) + WWH 2.6–3.0 ft @ 10s · face 2–4 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 3 ft @ 14s + W 1 ft @ 12s · SwD 202° SSW · wind W ~10 kt all morning

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

DAWN–9:30A · REEF TOO FULL	9:30A–NOON · LITTLE POINT, TEXTURED	NOON–1P · REEF NEAR FLOOR	AFTERNOON · LOW TIDE, W WIND, SHOWERS
WAIT	**GO**	**MEH**	**SKIP**



10:00a	GO · Little Point (bumpy)	3.6 ft tide	W ~9 kt · NWS	2–4 ft (SRF), S 15s + W windswell, bumpy

L 0.6 @ 1:09a · H 4.8 @ 7:34a · L 1.4 @ 1:33p · H 4.7 @ 7:26p · obs 5.6 @ 5:54a

Little Point, 9:30a to about noon, on the Anvil twin. Table tides: H 4.8 @ 7:34a, L 1.4 @ 1:33p, H 4.7 @ 7:26p. The gauge read 5.58 ft at 5:54a against about 4.2 predicted, so it is running about 1.35 ft over the table for the fourth day. That puts the reef near 6.1 ft at the high, over the 5.5 ft ceiling, then about 4.9 ft at 10a, 4.0 ft at 11a and 3.3 ft at noon. LJAC1 was W to WSW 5 to 13 kt from 4 to 5:18a (10 kt, gusting 11, at 5:18a). NWS hourly has W 10 mph from 6a through 2p, near calm at 3p, and a 38% chance of showers in the morning rising to 51% from 11a. PZZ740 has W 10 kt today with a slight chance of thunderstorms this afternoon.

Where it's working

Little Point

★

Top of the scorecard at 0.81. The S groundswell is still in (46258 SwH 0.9–1.0 m, 3.0–3.3 ft, @ 13–15s since 1:56a; 3.3 ft @ 15s SSW 202° at 5:26a), now with a 2.6–3.0 ft W windswell on top. The gauge read 5.58 ft at 5:54a against about 4.2 predicted, so it is running about 1.35 ft over the table. That puts the reef near 6.1 ft around the 7:34a high, over the 5.5 ft ceiling, then about 5.7 ft at 9a, 4.9 ft at 10a, 4.0 ft at 11a and 3.3 ft at noon, nearing the 3.0 ft floor by about 12:30. The catch is wind: W about 10 kt at LJAC1 and NWS W 10 mph all morning, so expect texture. Paddle out by 9:30.

CALL

2

PB Drive

Score 0.77. Same W wind, and the sandbar gets the windswell chop worse than the reef. Only if Little Point is crowded.

SOFT

3

Calumet

Score 0.61. Good swell angle but flagged tide-high vs its window on a gauge this full. Pass.

SOFT

4

PB north of the pier

Score 0.55. The SSW angle mostly misses the pier wedge, and the W wind blows straight in.

SOFT

•

Skip · Tourmaline (0.44) and PB Point (0.34) are too full on the high gauge, with high-tide mush at Tourmo. The Cliffs and OB want a bigger, cleaner W swell; today the W energy is short-period windswell. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) get the same W wind, so no reason to drive.

SKIP

BOARD

Anvil twin

~73°F

QUIVER

Anvil twin fish

Waist-to-chest faces with W chop on top. The twin keeps speed through the bumps, and with the Inferno gone it is the punchiest board you own.

TW log · too bumpy and too much push for it

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Long-period swell keeps its lines under a light onshore breeze.

A 15-second wave carries its energy deep below the surface, so a 10 kt breeze only roughs up the skin of it. Short 10-second windswell is shallower and gets pushed around much more. On a reef, the long-period sets still line up even when the surface looks messy, so wait for the set waves and let the in-between chop go by.

SKIP

Little Point before about 9:30a, while the gauge-adjusted high sits over the 5.5 ft ceiling, and after about 12:30p, when it drains toward the 3.0 ft floor. Calumet, Tourmo and PB Point on a gauge this full. The Cliffs and OB on a short-period W windswell. Any drive north, since the W wind is everywhere.

GOTCHAS

Water quality: NWS had showers in the forecast overnight and more today. If rain reached the coast, the county advises staying out for about 72 hours afterward, especially near storm drains and creek mouths. A slight chance of thunderstorms this afternoon (PZZ740), so get out at the first thunder. Moderate rip current risk (NWS SRF). Fifteen-second sets come in groups with long lulls under the chop, so watch a full set cycle before paddling out.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL · Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES